



Create A VCD Out Of Your Digital Photos

You always wanted to view a slideshow of your images on your big screen TV, but didn't know how to do it. Here's the lowdown

At some time, we have all been stranded because the people we wanted to share our digital photos with don't have a PC and making prints from digital photos is just too expensive. But with changes in technology, it is actually quite simple to create a VCD of your favourite photos and view them on a VCD player.

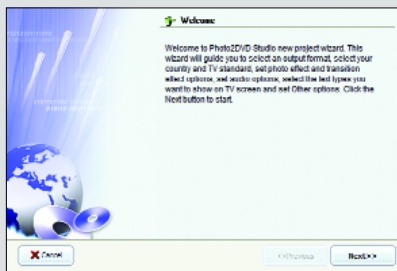
Before you start sending invites for the premiere, though, here are few things to do...

You will need software called photo2VCD. The trial version of this software can be downloaded from www.photo2vcd.com. You will also need a CD Writer to burn your final product on and a blank CD. And most importantly, you will need lots of digital photos! These obviously need to be on your PC.

1 STEP Getting Started

Download and install the trial version of the latest Photo2VCD Studio 3.0. On start, you will have the ubiquitous pop-up wizard which will pretty much beg you to help it create the VCD for you. Follow the simple steps and you should do fine. If you are a little more adventurous, click 'Cancel' and let's get our hands dirty!

The interface is really slick, albeit a little slow. It is divided into two panes like the



The Photo2vcd wizard

Windows Explorer. In the left pane, you can select your slideshows; each of these will be played as a single movie.

Once you have added photos to your

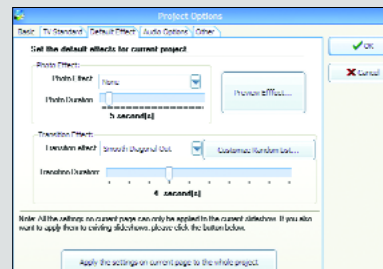


The main window

album, (you can also add multiple slideshows by clicking the button on the bottom left, labelled 'Add Slideshow'), you will need to arrange the photographs in the order you would like to show them. For this purpose, basic buttons such as Renaming, Removing and Rearranging a slideshow have been provided.

2 STEP Adding Effects

Now that you are done adding photos, let us add some effects to your transitions! To do this, click on the 'Options' button on top and you get a window, next to the 'Basic' tab that lets you choose between VCD, SVCD and DVD tabs for TV format (NTSC/PAL). If you are confused about this, just select your country and it will choose the right format. Effects, audio options and some other options are



The configuration window

found under the 'Options' tab.

The default 'Effect' tab will let you apply two kinds of effects: one to the photo itself and the other to the transition of one photo to another. It will also let you set the duration the photo is displayed for, the duration of the effect and has, of course, a huge list of effects to choose from.

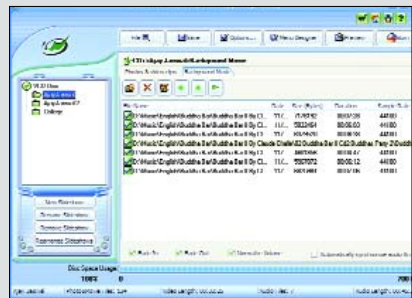
The default 'Effect' tab also has a neat feature that lets you preview the various effects before you actually apply them. It uses a preset image which morphs into another image using the effect settings which you choose.



Preview your effects

3 STEP Add Background Music

On the right, there are two more tabs. One that lets you add the photos or videos, while the second tab lets you can add custom background music. In order to do this, simply select the button with the musical note icon and select

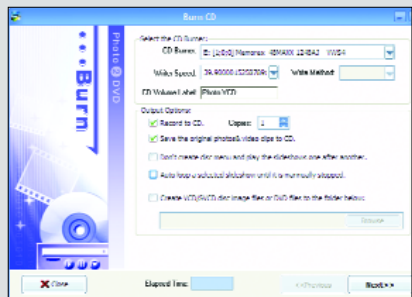


You can use MP3 and WAV files here

all the files you want. You also have the option of fading in/out and normalising the volume of your music files.

4 STEP Burn It!

Once you have configured the background music and photos and the various effects to your satisfaction, just hit the 'Burn' button on the top right and go make yourself some coffee and sandwiches and start sending the invites, for the



Burn your photos!

software takes some time to encode it to the VCD format and then of course, it needs to actually burn the CD.

Once it says 'Done', take your VCD out and pop it into any—old or new, cheap or expensive—VCD player and get nostalgic with those memories!

The trial version will add a stamp across your photos displaying the website name. If you do not want this, you could just buy the software for about \$39.95 or approximately Rs 1,800.